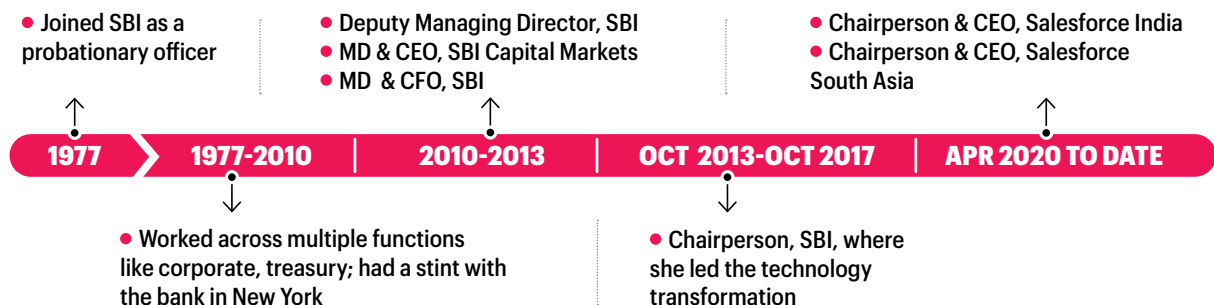


THE RISE



KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

SBI'S MERGER WITH FIVE ASSOCIATE BANKS

- State Bank of Bikaner & Jaipur
- State Bank of Hyderabad
- State Bank of Mysore
- State Bank of Patiala
- State Bank of Travancore

THE DIGITAL TRANSFORMATION

- Started off by opening six digital branches
- sbiINTOUCH allowed consumers to do basic activities
- Launched YONO, a mobile app in November 2017 that offers a digital bank, financial superstore, end-to-end digitisation and e-commerce
- Today, SBI's digitisation under Bhattacharya's leadership is considered to be a highly successful project

tually no entry barrier. "Earlier, you needed to know the language or coding or have some area of expertise. There will be a time when all of us will have a personal secretary who will be our agent."

Srivastava says it's remarkable what Bhattacharya has accomplished despite no formal training in technology. "Today, she speaks the language of tech easily," he says.

Going through the digital experience at SBI has, obviously, helped Bhattacharya run a digital-native organisation. "I had gone through the challenge of converting a traditional bank into a digitised platform. That exposure coupled with the nuances of a customer's point of view has made a big difference," she says.

Bhattacharya, says Srivastava, is a consensus builder. He draws an example from SBI's merger with associate banks. "The key lay in harmonising a complicated process. Appreciating the granularity of the process across various verticals and getting all concerned on the same page was not easy, but once that was done, it became seamless." Inevitably, the vertical heads too played their part. "But the real force was the person leading the process. She intervened only when there was a need," he says, before adding Bhattacharya is "a compassionate leader but with a mind of her own."

Bhattacharya's journey has had many milestones. However, she does not forget the role that her mother and aunt played—"both were very strong women"—and how they influenced her. "My husband is all about giving me space. He has never been interfering and never held me back," she says. At 70, her enthusiasm for anything she does is infectious. Of course there is commitment, but more than anything else, it is a lesson that one must enjoy what one is doing. It could be running a bank or a tech organisation or just watching a show on Netflix. **BT**

@krishmagopalan

that IT is a future-facing business. "If you don't prepare for what lies ahead, you are likely to become irrelevant."

In many ways, banking and IT are about high-quality customer service. "You must understand what customers want. It includes the pain points and keeping one's word on delivery," says Bhattacharya. She views the current phase as "democratisation of IT" where there is vir-